

## Evaluation of *Crocus sativus* L. (saffron) on male erectile dysfunction: a pilot study.

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In this study, the effect of *Crocus sativus* (saffron) was studied on male erectile dysfunction (ED). Twenty male patients with ED were followed for ten days in which each morning they took a tablet containing 200mg of saffron. Patients underwent the nocturnal penile tumescence (NPT) test and the international index of erectile function questionnaire (IIEF-15) at the start of the treatment and at the end of the ten days. After the ten days of taking saffron there was a statistically significant improvement in tip rigidity and tip tumescence as well as base rigidity and base tumescence. IIEF-15 total scores were significantly higher in patients after saffron treatment (before treatment 22.15 $\pm$ 1.44; after treatment 39.20 $\pm$ 1.90,  $p < 0.001$ ). Saffron showed a positive effect on sexual function with increased number and duration of erectile events seen in patients with ED even only after taking it for ten days.